General rule – Advantage and Disadvantage · "Playing the Game" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

When a rule gives you **Advantage**, you roll **two d20s** for a D20 Test and use the **higher** roll. With **Disadvantage**, you roll two d20s and use the **lower** one. Modifiers are added only once.

Advantage and Disadvantage **don't stack**: you always roll two dice, even with several sources. If you have **at least one Advantage and one Disadvantage**, they cancel out: roll one d20.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Advantage: **two d20s**, use the higher.
2. Disadvantage: **two d20s**, use the lower.
3. Several sources: **no stacking**, always two dice.
4. Advantage and Disadvantage: they **cancel**, one d20.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 confirms that Advantage and Disadvantage cancel even with several sources, and that **rerolling** a die (Heroic Inspiration) applies to a single d20.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text is vague on when Advantage applies (before the roll). Fix: announce Advantage **before** rolling.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe why Advantage applies ("he's caught off guard"), so players remember the cause.

Step 1 – Count the sources:

List the Advantages and Disadvantages that apply to the roll.

Step 2 – Compare:

Advantage alone: Advantage; Disadvantage alone: Disadvantage; both: one d20, no Advantage or Disadvantage.

Step 3 – Roll the dice:

Two d20s if Advantage or Disadvantage, otherwise one.

Step 4 – Keep the right one:

Higher for Advantage, lower for Disadvantage.

Step 5 – Add modifiers:

Add them once, to the kept die.

Example: Brann attacks a Prone enemy (Advantage) but is Poisoned (Disadvantage): they cancel, he rolls one d20.

⚠ Common questions:

Do two Advantages give three dice?

No: always two d20s.

One Advantage and two Disadvantages?

They cancel: one d20.

Can I reroll with Advantage?

Yes: reroll just one die, your choice.

Does Advantage work on damage?

No: only on D20 Tests.

A natural 20 with Advantage?

Counts as a natural 20 (automatic hit for attacks).

Does Advantage apply to saves?

Yes, if a rule says so.

Can I choose not to use it?

No: Advantage is mandatory.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Partial cancellation

Do one Advantage and two Disadvantages cancel? **Option**: follow the SRD (yes).

"Permanent" Advantage

A feature that always gives Advantage. **Option**: keep it.

Several Advantage sources

Nothing beyond one Advantage. **Option**: give +1 to the die? Not recommended.

Range Disadvantage

Combining long range and cover: Disadvantage stays single. **Option**: keep it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Reroll

Rerolling a d20 with Advantage: reroll one of the two dice and keep the better.

Natural number

A natural 20 is judged on the kept die.

Heroic Inspiration

Lets you reroll a die; you must keep the new result.

No effect on damage

Advantage never applies to damage rolls.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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